

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 23

MICHIGAN

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Michigan's family courts and child-welfare system.

200

MICHIGAN FAMILIES ON RECORD · 389 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
NOVEMBER 7, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
59 OF 83

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · MICHIGAN

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Michigan. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Charles Simon III

JUDGE · MONTCALM COUNTY MICHIGAN · **9 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He makes decisions in his chambers before court proceedings happens. Before hearing any thing. He slanders the parents in court, tells you how much he thinks your a piece of crap."*

> *"Sent a detective to my home to question my about a tik tok repost that he was informed about by " one of his minions". After that he removed himself from my case admitting bias."*

> *"Doesn't allow evidence or you to defend yourself. Biased. Not for families Biased. Not for families He's a biased lying judge who is against families"* MONTCALM

> *"Very prejudiced against my family, talked down to us in court. Judge Simons Rude, judgemental, prejudice. Talked down to us in open court."*

> *"He lied and said my daughter threatened to kill him. To get himself off the case because he broke so many laws and rules."*

> *"He has violated my rights and been overturned by the court of appeals. His biggest goal is to delay, delay, delay."* MONTCALM

> *"He did not listen to childrens wishes or needs, did not let my parents speak, did an ex parte to take visits away."*

> *"Ignored evidence and denied reunification.we have not seen or heard from our child in 4 years"*

> *"He is bias? And has a drug problem"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-charles-simon-iii/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Karen McFadden

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · MONTCALM · **9 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Told me she would fight for me to come home in court but then also told me that she would not fight for my siblings because I was treated differently and that my parents had no right to have their other kids back and she would trash talk my parents to me, she lied in court paperwork"*

> *"Misrepresented children, lied about what they really wanted. Lied about what the children said. Still misrepresting children. Keeps children away from there siblings. Lied to children about the case."*

> *"Cyber stalks me and submits shared posts to the court about my outcry of unjust actions. Supports and defends the department when their own attorney is not present."*

> *"Karen McFadden was the 3rd GAL my family had in the 2 years we went threw Montcalm county. She was cruel and didn't listen to what my children had to say."*

> *"She lis Everytime she opens her mouth. She said I prostituted my daughter as a child. That is a lie and could have had me on charges."*

> *"The GAL has tried to get me fired from every job I've worked at since the proceeding began."*

> *"Fabricated stories about relatives. Foster parents are her friends"*

> *"Gave false information"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-karen-mcfadden/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Brian Kirkham

JUDGE · CALHOUN · **7 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Horrible judge had proof of dads medical neglect, drinking and driving, nothing i did was change enough to get custody Sided with dad on multiple occasions even when not in best interests of my daughter. Gave dad full custody of my youngest at the time, even with reunification in place, cps case was kept open for 2 years and they made it impossible for me to get my kids back and keep them. Not allowing me to live with family in a safe environment instead drug infested apartment housing. The list is long I have been removed from central Registry because I don't fit the neglect abuse criteria"*

> *"Motion was filed for referee, molder's orders. But since my orders were sent to a different address, Judge Kirkham through the motion out and forced child support child time and custody all to be filed based off allegations and false information. Told me to come back after dna test results to change the orders."*

> *"Laughed at the other attorney lying about transcript and a witnessed credibility, refused to look at the evidence or proof just denyed my objection."*

> *"He ignored my clear evidence of my exes csc charge and evidence of another sex offender living with him and still granted him full custody."*
> CALHOUN COUNTY

> *"No due process twice! Ex parte with sworn affidavit of no child abuse. Still to this day -year to date no visitation."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-brian-kirkham/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Travis Carr

ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · MONTCALM · **7 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Misrepresented me, threatens me, refused to call witness's in a major court proceeding, spoke to the judge about about things I did not know, also things I did not want him to, the. Went on to represent my children in the same case, That is a clear conflict of interest. Also held an ex parte hearing that we never had a court hearing to, and filed for termination of parental rights."*

> *"Travis Carr was first my husband's Lawyer in this case for 1 day covering for his actual lawyer, and a few months later he was then my kids 2nd GAL in this case. When it came to termination of rights they finally then decided it was a conflict of interest. This man represented my husband and my children in the same case. How is that fair? It's not."*

> *"He met with us literally once and then lied about everything we said in the court paperwork. He talked to me for maybe 10 to 20 minutes everything that he had written in the paperwork that I said had to at least have been in hours zoom not no 10-20 minutes."*

> *"Lied on the record to the Judge, after a closed meeting with my children and without my daughter representation present."*

> *"Told my boyfriend to file for custody of our daughter & leave me to go raise our daughter"*

> *"Told my grandson to lie in court to get charges on himself dropped"*

> *"Tell me to leave my\nSignificant other"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-travis-carr/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Lisa Gorcyca CONTINUED 1 / 2

JUDGE · OAKLAND · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"I had a court order concerning threats being made by my ex. As Pro Se I requested that the court order be fulfilled. I was not allowed to finish going through my motion before Judge Gorcyca allowed the opposing counsel to interrupt me. They both decided that it was 'past the time' for the court order to be fulfilled. Another item, Judge Gorcyca would not follow the JOD. Tutoring was supposed to be paid by both. Even though I had a 2 doctor's stating tutoring was needed for my daughter's dyslexia, I still had to to pay for it by myself. Last, the Judge was supposed to review the evidence in my case. Instead she decided to 'trust' the opposing counsel and not review the evidence. The opposing counsel manipulated the facts to the point one could construe that here statements were false. In her judgement she put me down viciously when all I was doing was trying to get some fairness, and equal treatment by the FOC."*

> *"He ignored everything that she ordered and did not make my ex do it and only me, even though she ordered and threatened him with jail over it she just kept sweeping it under the rock where I finally gave up pressure in it. She said stuff on the record I have court transcripts to prove it even brought them into her to remind her and she pretty much told me too bad. I don't care what I said previously I'm gonna change it just to make your ex happy for whatever reason it was disgusting I don't know what she had going on with him, but there was something. He had a lawyer and his lawyer was actually a pretty shady person himself, but he my ex would laugh at me and say that him and the judge were at parties together, so I would never beat him and that he keep getting away with it."*

> *"She pushed my trial 3 time with no explanation. Then stated she was not going to look at all the evidence of a disabled child being abused / neglected by his mother. She signed off and granted the stop of a surgery that our special needs child needs to breath better. Clearly not in the best interest of the child. Not sure. Postponed the trial 3 times now nothing"*

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Lisa Gorcyca CONTINUED 2 / 2

JUDGE · OAKLAND · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She has on several occasions, denied motions for support enforcement and for parenting time adjustment... " I was left home alone, so no harm no foul" at the time, my daughter was between ages of four and 10 and was left in a hotel room alone while her dad and her stepmother went to the casino, gambling and drinking"*

> *"Signed all court documents and went along with whatever the referee, child protective services, and the pediatrician stated although is false information."* OAKLAND COUNTY COURT, PONTIAC MICHIGAN

> *"Lisa Gorcyca pushed me into an unfair settlement with my abusive ex husband."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-lisa-gorcyca/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Katherine "Katie" Zopf CONTINUED 1 / 2

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · OAKLAND · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"In my opinion, the GAL assigned to my case is not impartial and failed to act in my child's best interests. Throughout this process, I felt that recommendations were made to support predetermined outcomes rather than to objectively evaluate the facts and circumstances of the case. What has been particularly concerning is that the same GAL continues to be appointed in cases before the same judge, despite widespread concerns expressed by parents who have appeared before them. Over the course of this litigation, I have spoken with numerous mothers who have had experiences with this judge and GAL, and many expressed similar concerns regarding fairness, objectivity, and accountability. The perception among many parents is that recommendations are often accepted without meaningful scrutiny, even when significant evidence exists to the contrary. This creates a sense that outcomes are predetermined and that parents are not receiving the independent evaluation that a GAL is supposed to provide. Whether those concerns are ultimately justified is for others to determine. What I can say is that my experience left me with little confidence that my voice, my concerns, or the evidence I presented were given fair consideration. The consequences for my son and for my family have been profound."* 6TH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT (OAKLAND COUNTY)

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Katherine "Katie" Zopf CONTINUED 2 / 2

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · OAKLAND · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She falsified court documents stating that my home was not safe. She testified that I told her this and I did not. She also sent my 5 year old child to be tested for ADHD without including his past medical history and encouraging me to administer 15 mg of Adderrall to my at the time 5 year old child who did not display any behaviors/and or symptoms of ADHD. She over charged for basically no service. She also failed to speak with my family and get the proper information for the case. She suggested that my child should not stay overnight at my home, and never visited my home. She suggested the administering of medicine by Zoom everyday with the father to monitor. Even though I gave my son the medicine against my own will and judgement she accused me of not giving it. It was recoreded daily and sent to my attorney. This affected my custody. Falsified records and recommended my son not return home provided false testimony without speaking to me or visiting my home Provided false testimony, ordered stop visitation with my son without evidence"*

> *"From the 1st time my daughter disclosed CSA, she has lied to the court about the status of the CPS investigation. She took away my parenting time and I had to jump through multiple hoops over a year to get custody of my daughter back. A year later, my daughter disclosed again. This time her forensic interview resulted in CPS filing to terminate the parental rights of my daughter's father. The GAL lied to the court on March 24, 2021 saying that CPS had no filed to terminate parental rights. She claimed i was also being investigated. And she asked thst she be able to do her own investigation. The Judge turned her into an L-GAL. She then worked with the court-appointed child psychologist to create an affidavit claiming my daughter recanted. She had the psychologist send that to the prosecutor, who then declined to press charges due to conflicting evidence. She admitted this in the recorded in July 2021."*

> *"When I was in DV shelter, rather than call me or respond to my attorney, she filed a missing persons report against me and called the police numerous times to make it seem like I was endangering the kids."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-katherine-katie-zopf/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Tasha Welch

THERAPIST / COUNSELOR · MONTCALM · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Didn't follow the d h s book was never notified that my daughter was in the hospital when we still had medical rights"*

> *"Hides the domestic violence in placements home, while stating it was in my home with zero history of DV in my home."*

> *"She makes up things that never happened even when it's recorded and they believe her and won't take the recording"*

> *"Is rude & bitchy!"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-tasha-welch/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Emily Davidson

CPS WORKER · MONTCALM COUNTY MICHIGAN · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Lies about literally everything doesn't fight for any reunification whatsoever, she will sit there and be so nice to you and she will tell you that you're doing so good in that she wouldn't lie to you and that you're going to get your kids back soon because you're doing awesome but then she'll go back and put in the paperwork nothing good that you did she'll go in the paperwork and lie and just write a bunch of bad things that happen that never actually happened."* MONTCALM

> *"Falsifys evidence, lies about children's wants and needs. Lies to the children about the case. Puts children into dangerous situons/homes,rather then Return them to there safenvironment. Perjurs herself repeatly."* MONTCALM COUNTY MICHIGAN

> *"Emily Davidson was our CPS case worker that was supposed to be helping us get the kids back. She consistantly lied to us and on reports to the judge. Impeded our progress."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-emily-davidson/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Eric W. Cholack

JUDGE · WAYNE · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Cholak never let me have a trail he would schedule the trail then have the Attorney's and GAL go to chambers then come out and have me state i did not want the trial well here is the truth he told my attorney if we go through with the trail he already decided for my ex. even when my ex and the current GF went on a 3 month shoplifting spree and got caught by Kohl's even when my ex moved 4 different time and even when my ex had 4 different GF's and insisted my son call them MOM the GAL would only bring up my past but was Abies for my ex because he was in the Army not to mention the Army my ex was DC for being LAZY and could not meet expectation and was liable on the Aircraft he was in charge of that same Aircraft crashed during a Training mission that caused the pilot and copilot to die. Cholack would not allow that into evidence. Cholack would not look at the time my ex beat one of my sons butt so bad he was purple for 3 weeks instead i had to go to therapy. Meanwhile Cholack would cancel court dates hoping i would just go away Cholack drug my case out so much that my sons became 18 never listen to my side i had 15 witness judge made his decision that my ex was a better parent ex only worked 17 hours a week 4 different GF's 4 different places he moved oh the best part his 2 gf and him went on a 2 county crime spree shoplifting with her kid and mine robbing Kohl's got caught Judge Cholak did not think that was a bad thing"*

> *"Allowed my ex husband to continue to abuse me and my children and he didn't lose custody"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-eric-w-cholack/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Lisa Langton

JUDGE · GENESEE · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Failed to review current situations with girls focused on half brothers case more. Refused to hear other testimony and group 2 different people together based on three other children's removal"*

> *"Denied my motions on several occasions, is on record stating "I don't care what the child wants I will not interview them" "I don't owe you an explanation" "I am the end all be all ""* OAKLAND

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-lisa-langton/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Lori Shearer

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · MONTCALM COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"My eldest daughter got in some trouble with truancy at school, and Lori Shearer represented my daughter, kept trying to force her take a plea deal, when we refused they dismissed the case, then when Cps got involved Lori Shearer represented my kids again, where she completely and utterly used every single thing we told her personally against us. It's was biased to make her my children's GAL. She didn't listen to the kids and lied on the stand and fabricated evidence. Prejudiced. Was My eldest daughters trucnat lawyer before this case. Had a conflict of interest as she represented my little brother in a different case."*

> *"She represented my uncle knowing he was family because we all have the same last name. She was also my lawyer for truency."* MONTCALM

> *"Falsifys evidence, doesn't listen to the children to what they want and needs. Misrepresentes the kids wants and needs."* MONTCALM COUNTY MICHIGAN

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-lori-shearer/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Marc Crotteau

JUDGE · CALHOUN · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He also took two cases at the same time, which was my girlfriend's case in my case a custody he didn't recuse himself from one and he used my girlfriend's to coincide with my case."*

> *"Ignored evidence, wrote my court order based on hearsay, labeling my partner a alcoholic with domestic violence tendencies even though we had his counselor testify on his sobriety."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-marc-crotteau/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Michelle Lyons

ATTORNEY (MINE) · MONTCALM · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Did not present evidence we had to the courts. Asked that lawyer represent my family the way a lawyer is supposed to. It was not done."*

> *"Represented my wife, lied, falysfied evidence. Held Ex parte hearings without wife present."*

> *"Told me to sign over my kids & go have more babies."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mi-michelle-lyons/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

MICHIGAN AT A GLANCE.

Across 200 Michigan families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
389
199 of 200 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$104,500
median across 86 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
18
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
44.0%
88 of 200 who answered; 79 of 200 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
200	2.0	199 of 200	59

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Michigan families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF MICHIGAN FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	121	$20,000	$65,999	$7,985,922
Lost Wages	96	$10,000	$56,128	$5,388,258
Other Court Fees	65	$1,500	$14,941	$971,171
Therapy / Evaluations	75	$2,000	$6,312	$473,431
Reunification Services	50	$300	$4,906	$245,296
GAL Fees	54	$3,000	$9,121	$492,551
Asset Loss [1]	81	$40,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (86 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$104,500	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($40,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	18	1.5 yrs
Mean months lost	33	2.8 yrs
Total across all families	4,613	384.4 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · MICHIGAN

Most families documenting in Michigan are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	98	49%
Case closed: within last 2 years	28	14%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	21	11%
Not provided	21	11%
Active case: progress being made	18	9%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	98	49%
Family Court Only	80	40%
CPS Only	11	6%
Unknown	10	5%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)	1	0%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	67	34%
5 – 10 years	37	19%
3 – 5 years	30	15%
Over 10 years	28	14%
Less than 6 months	16	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	46	23%
Visitation Only	45	22%
50/50 Joint	41	20%
Full Custody	26	13%
Children in Foster Care	21	10%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Oakland	30	17%
Wayne	19	11%
Montcalm	14	8%
Calhoun	12	7%
Macomb	9	5%
Kent	8	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	61	30%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	45	22%
High Conflict Divorce	26	13%
Other	19	10%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	16	8%

05 PARENT VOICES — MICHIGAN

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Michigan comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *They have ripped 3 very important years from me and my girls after a decade long with my abuser I was finally leaving and instead of helping me they took my kids because of his actions this has been devastating and will never be the same they have my me feel completely defeated [...]*
>
> — KELLY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My husband recorded my daughter through the bathroom window at my home. I called Ashley child advocacy center and also took her for a forensic interview. At that time we both did a police interview. I picked up my husband after work and took him to turn in his phone and [...]

— MICHIGAN PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM MICHIGAN

They stole my children and gave my ex sole physical and legal custody. No convictions or abuse allegations or charges. NO CPS involvement

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed the fabric of my family and my whole existence! 5 children ripped from their mother!

— AMYJO

Ripped us apart and traumatized my children

— SIERRA

Ripped my family in half. Sold two kids to abusers Jason and Jessica Klimp.

— STACY

This system stole everything from me from my own birth mother and my siblings to my own God given gifts, I was mos!ted in the foster care system and by my birth father and dhhs and cps knew they separated me from my brothers because I was speaking up they kidnapped my babies. [...]

— SHIANNE

The entire system (police, CPS caseworkers, judges, etc.) works together on an agenda most of us have no idea is being imposed onto us until our banks are empty, our kids are trafficked into the system, and we are too broke, too destroyed and too heartbroken to do anything about [...]

— ANITA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Destroyed me and my children mentally and physically for life and left us homeless and violated many laws and constitional rights.*
>
> — KATHY

They have mentally and emotionally ruined me as a mother, taking my kids away. They have stripped my kids from the home, causing mental and emotional trauma to the three children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is ripped our family completely apart my three year old has never been away from me or his father he's terrified we went to a visit with him and he was so upset he started puking all over my boyfriend they have ripped us apart and kept us apart we're going on almost 2 weeks [...]

— NAOMI

I left everything the judge flipped everything on me and took kids gave him 80%. They are coming home with welts, brides, smack marks, cps doesnt care. My kids won't talk cause he said he would k.ll me. There is so much I have 2 yrs of documentation and 1.5 of abuse videos??

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have spent 19 years in fear because of the wrong doing. After they terminated my rights I was diagnosed as ptsd and severe agoraphobia. Since my kids turned 18 they have come home but cps still terrorizes me for my five younger children. Threats of using my 19 year old case to [...]

— AMY

The system has traumatized us, used us, abused us, ignored us, and tried to break down our mental well-being.

— STACEY

It has stolen our time and destroyed our belief in this country, while it shattered our voices leaving us to pick up the pieces.

— STACI

The system and destroyed my family, my bond with my children and had a court ordered divorce.

— KAYC

This destroyed my family. I have lost my children. My wife and I dont get a long well. Our married may beyond repair. I miss my babies.

— SHAWN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They are givingmy children childhood trauma for no reason. I was trying to break generational curses.*
>
> — HALLIE

https://voiceofdetroit.net/2016/05/01/hearing-on-disabled-abused-child-may-2-why-does-judge-martha-snow-endanger-janna-jail-mom/

— SHANNON (DEBACKER)

Four children who had suffered severe neglect and sexual abuse from their mother and live in boyfriend were forced to unsupervised visits after two years because the GAL (who never visited the children or expressed their wishes) lied to the judge. The Judge ignored the safety [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The has torn my family of 4 to shreds, creating irreparable damage and trauma that will take years to learn how to cope with such loss. It has taken my ability as a mother to help my children heal, together as a family through this process.

— ALEXANDRA

The family court system has destroyed my children and I.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has completely ruined my family and almost destroyed my marriage. They've traumatized my children the same way they traumatized me as a child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Made me send my kids to be further abused by their father

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have no faith in the courts. Wrong is made right. Right is made wrong,, and my child was destroyed. Thankfully my Attorney is now the judge and she's amazing.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The hurt is unmeasurable. Total loss of fairness and justice in the court that is supposed to serve and protect the people and children. Instead it's ripping them apart and destroying them. The trauma is coming from the court.

— KATHY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *The greatest pain was not only surviving abuse. It was watching a system built to protect children knowingly empower it. For years, I fought not just one man, but an entire network of silence, favoritism, and indifference. I lost financially. I lost physically. I lost pieces of [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed our whole lives. Drove my love to committ suicide. Robbed us of time with my kids!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed my reputation as they tried to criminalized me for standing up for myself, and representing myself, they have jailed me for contempt, which reduced illegally coercion and intimidation, use school board officials and teachers against me, they dragged this for [...]

— JAYLYNN

Typical DARVO case but I discovered the GAL sold him custody. Then I discovered how they used psychology torture on me that gave me PTSD.

— DEANNA

While we are still going through this terrible process, my 2 children have been removed from my full-time care and I now have to share 50-50 custody with the man that wrecked our family with physical, verbal, emotional, and financial abuse to both the children and me (the same [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Mark Braunlich, Sarah Blanchett, Patrice Patrick, Stephanie LaPrad are corrupt. They are breaking the law.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Because of the school counselors actions my (grand)children were extremely terrified and angry. A lot of past trauma was dug up to satisfy her own curiosity. She counseled 2 of my grandkids every week for a year without my knowledge or consent. Bribed my grandkids with toys to [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *2600000 dollars ,everything that it destroyed my kids and left us homeless and ptsd for both my kids and me ..*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has absolutely ruined me and my kids lives I cry everyday, as do they they have PTSD and so do I. I am halfway suicidal from all of this.

— JENNIFER

"CPS didn't just take my children—it fractured our family, leaving behind a pain that reshaped every part of our lives. We're still fighting to heal from something that changed us forever."

— SAMANTHA

It destroyed my family. My children are not even allowed to see each other now.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am a mother who is only allowed to raise half my children, because of "predicted harm"

— AMBER

Has destroyed my relationship with my children, my community, and has breached my constitutional rights even though I proven that mother is an unfit mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

If I were to describe what is being done to these children and families in the system in one word, it would be torture

— SYDNEY

This system did not just break apart my marriage, it destabilized my entire family by turning loss into years of financial pressure, legal battles, and emotional damage. It has strained my relationship with my children, stripped away stability, and made rebuilding feel like [...]

— PAUL

The system enabled domestic violence and terror upon me and the kids and it severed my bond with my twins.

— STEPHANIE

They have failed us. Always gave the mother what she requested. Ignored emotional abuse to the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Emotional strain , separation between siblings in the home, cost me my job ,my rights .

— DAVID

137 Michigan parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — MICHIGAN

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Michigan families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> They have ripped 3 very important years from me and my girls after a decade long with my abuser I was finally leaving and instead of helping me they took my kids because of his actions this has been devastating and will never be the same they have my me feel completely defeated not to mention the false positive drug screen I had that set me back 6 months
>
> — KELLY

> They stole my children and gave my ex sole physical and legal custody. No convictions or abuse allegations or charges. NO CPS involvement
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Destroyed the fabric of my family and my whole existence! 5 children ripped from their mother!
>
> — AMYJO

> Ripped us apart and traumatized my children
>
> — SIERRA

> Ripped my family in half. Sold two kids to abusers Jason and Jessica Klimp.
>
> — STACY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My husband recorded my daughter through the bathroom window at my home. I called Ashley child advocacy center and also took her for a forensic interview. At that time we both did a police interview. I picked up my husband after work and took him to turn in his phone and interview. At first he denied. At that time my daughter (15) was unsure if he did it and he had a believable story. He stayed roughly 1 month until he admitted and moved out. I called the police and he turned himself in. The court opened a case and stated he was the respondant. The day of court I became the respindant, got placed in front of an attorney with a list of allegations, and sat infront of the judge. I had asked in court if my husband could live in the apartment in the barn with no unsupervised contact and no access to the house (i was a stay at home mom and home schooled at the time) they took my children that day and placed them in kinship care. They claimed mental and emotional neglect and academic neglect (3 of my children have IEPs and have been in public school and continue to fall behind. I was a substitute and decided to home school this year. Since they have court ordered my children to return to public school). This story goes on. This is just day one This has been awful and has destroyed my family in ways I cant explain. I lost my husband one day amd two days later had my children ripped. I'm so tired and broken. They are home but so lost. My son almost got admitting inpatient psychiatric because separation anxiety is so bad he has became unsafe. He is 7 years old. My life Is turned upside down and they still have jurisdiction and FRP is involved. Next hearing is beginning of March.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system stole everything from me from my own birth mother and my siblings to my own God given gifts, I was mos!ted in the foster care system and by my birth father and dhhs and cps knew they separated me from my brothers because I was speaking up they kidnapped my babies. They prey on people that seek help from the government and they add more pain and suffering to the situations. I used to believe heros existed but the heroes protect the corruption by being silent and not speaking up. I am my kids amor I didn't know my laws or rights or what they did but now I know I will hold them accountable for 6 years stolen from me being a first time mother that can't carry anymore babies due to my health

— SHIANNE

The entire system (police, CPS caseworkers, judges, etc.) works together on an agenda most of us have no idea is being imposed onto us until our banks are empty, our kids are trafficked into the system, and we are too broke, too destroyed and too heartbroken to do anything about it. They destroyed my family, the health of my children and myself, stole my house, my kids and all my belongings, but what they didn’t do, was kill me, and my good spirit but they prob should have! To all parents: STAY AWAY FROM FAMILY COURT! It’s not safe for anyone right now. None of the courts are.

— ANITA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed me and my children mentally and physically for life and left us homeless and violated many laws and constitional rights.

— KATHY

They have mentally and emotionally ruined me as a mother, taking my kids away. They have stripped my kids from the home, causing mental and emotional trauma to the three children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is ripped our family completely apart my three year old has never been away from me or his father he's terrified we went to a visit with him and he was so upset he started puking all over my boyfriend they have ripped us apart and kept us apart we're going on almost 2 weeks now I have no legal representation for myself because they can afford an attorney I fired Marie Walker because she was for them not me they've cost us money pain and suffering trauma and we plan on suing

— NAOMI

I left everything the judge flipped everything on me and took kids gave him 80%. They are coming home with welts, brides, smack marks, cps doesnt care. My kids won't talk cause he said he would k.ll me. There is so much I have 2 yrs of documentation and 1.5 of abuse videos??

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have spent 19 years in fear because of the wrong doing. After they terminated my rights I was diagnosed as ptsd and severe agoraphobia. Since my kids turned 18 they have come home but cps still terrorizes me for my five younger children. Threats of using my 19 year old case to take my five children now.

— AMY

The system has traumatized us, used us, abused us, ignored us, and tried to break down our mental well-being.

— STACEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has stolen our time and destroyed our belief in this country, while it shattered our voices leaving us to pick up the pieces.

— STACI

The system and destroyed my family, my bond with my children and had a court ordered divorce.

— KAYC

This destroyed my family. I have lost my children. My wife and I dont get a long well. Our married may beyond repair. I miss my babies.

— SHAWN

They are givingmy children childhood trauma for no reason. I was trying to break generational curses.

— HALLIE

https://voiceofdetroit.net/2016/05/01/hearing-on-disabled-abused-child-may-2-why-does-judge-martha-snow-endanger-janna-jail-mom/

— SHANNON (DEBACKER)

Four children who had suffered severe neglect and sexual abuse from their mother and live in boyfriend were forced to unsupervised visits after two years because the GAL (who never visited the children or expressed their wishes) lied to the judge. The Judge ignored the safety risks and professional recommendations of service providers. The children continue to be at risk of further sexual abuse and exploitation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The has torn my family of 4 to shreds, creating irreparable damage and trauma that will take years to learn how to cope with such loss. It has taken my ability as a mother to help my children heal, together as a family through this process.

— ALEXANDRA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The family court system has destroyed my children and I.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has completely ruined my family and almost destroyed my marriage. They've traumatized my children the same way they traumatized me as a child.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Made me send my kids to be further abused by their father
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I have no faith in the courts. Wrong is made right. Right is made wrong,, and my child was destroyed. Thankfully my Attorney is now the judge and she's amazing.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The hurt is unmeasurable. Total loss of fairness and justice in the court that is supposed to serve and protect the people and children. Instead it's ripping them apart and destroying them. The trauma is coming from the court.
>
> — KATHY

> The greatest pain was not only surviving abuse. It was watching a system built to protect children knowingly empower it. For years, I fought not just one man, but an entire network of silence, favoritism, and indifference. I lost financially. I lost physically. I lost pieces of myself emotionally. Yet the greatest loss was the years stolen from my children's peace and innocence. Courts speak of "the best interests of the child," but too often they ignore the terror of forcing victims to remain tied to their abusers through custody and parenting coordination. Justice without courage is not justice at all.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Destroyed our whole lives. Drove my love to committ suicide. Robbed us of time with my kids!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have destroyed my reputation as they tried to criminalized me for standing up for myself, and representing myself, they have jailed me for contempt, which reduced illegally coercion and intimidation, use school board officials and teachers against me, they dragged this for so long with so many unnecessary hearings that I lost two jobs my home, my car and some other possessions, they removed my custody so I have no rights to my son except a little bit of visitation they allowed him to move with my son over an hour away that I can't get to.

— JAYLYNN

Typical DARVO case but I discovered the GAL sold him custody. Then I discovered how they used psychology torture on me that gave me PTSD.

— DEANNA

While we are still going through this terrible process, my 2 children have been removed from my full-time care and I now have to share 50-50 custody with the man that wrecked our family with physical, verbal, emotional, and financial abuse to both the children and me (the same man that got a one bedroom apartment that didn't take kids when he moved out). He also forged documents for our businesses, the IRS, and I have lost $3-4 million through deception, forgery, and blatant abuse of the legal system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Mark Braunlich, Sarah Blanchett, Patrice Patrick, Stephanie LaPrad are corrupt. They are breaking the law.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Because of the school counselors actions my (grand)children were extremely terrified and angry. A lot of past trauma was dug up to satisfy her own curiosity. She counseled 2 of my grandkids every week for a year without my knowledge or consent. Bribed my grandkids with toys to talk to her and then reported me for abuse. It was found unsubstantiated and the case was dropped. The cops worker tried to get me to sign a parenting plan (I refused) and also wanted all 5 of my children to do a forensic interview including a 6 mth old baby at the time. (I refused)

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

2600000 dollars ,everything that it destroyed my kids and left us homeless and ptsd for both my kids and me ..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has absolutely ruined me and my kids lives I cry everyday, as do they they have PTSD and so do I. I am halfway suicidal from all of this.

— JENNIFER

“CPS didn’t just take my children—it fractured our family, leaving behind a pain that reshaped every part of our lives. We’re still fighting to heal from something that changed us forever.”

— SAMANTHA

It destroyed my family. My children are not even allowed to see each other now.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am a mother who is only allowed to raise half my children, because of "predicted harm"

— AMBER

Has destroyed my relationship with my children, my community, and has breached my constitutional rights even though I proven that mother is an unfit mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

If I were to describe what is being done to these children and families in the system in one word, it would be torture

— SYDNEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system did not just break apart my marriage, it destabilized my entire family by turning loss into years of financial pressure, legal battles, and emotional damage. It has strained my relationship with my children, stripped away stability, and made rebuilding feel like surviving a punishment that never ends.

— PAUL

The system enabled domestic violence and terror upon me and the kids and it severed my bond with my twins.

— STEPHANIE

They have failed us. Always gave the mother what she requested. Ignored emotional abuse to the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Emotional strain , separation between siblings in the home, cost me my job ,my rights .

— DAVID

Raped me of the opportunity to be a mother & Deprived my children of growing up with a mom, and made me cold and dead behind the eyes.

— CHRISTINA

Destroyed my family, lost my home and has ruined her siblings relationships

— DEAN

Erased my motherhood and all my children’s loving memories

— BRANDEE

Completely destroyed my home, my life, my kids and family irreparably

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system did not benefit our family in any way because they medically kidnapped my granddaughter on false allegations and coercion! We are a disabled veteran household with autism in our family history and CPS used everything against us without proof!

— TERI

Proper policy and procedure was not followed. Removed my kids in violation of my constitutional rights. Keeps delaying so temporary orders keep in effect. State now my children are “thriving” without me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Organizations like CPS originally was founded with good intentions, now they are just leaching taxpayers dollars, using them and abusing them with their own money. They intentionally hire poorly trained and poorly paid staff, whose livelihoods depend on getting paid through the state, including poorly performed, failing attorneys. This, in turn, gives them the state affiliation and guaranteed income that isn't performance- based. None, I repeat, NONE OF THESE PEOPLE have genuine interest and care for the children they allegedly help, but essentially break.

— TATIANA

The litigation abuse and trauma from the last 5 years has resulted in me developing an autoimmune disorder. When the Defendant filed a motion to compel discovery on my daughter's 10th birthday, it suffered a TIA while responding to their motion. I have also lost jobs because of them.

— MELISSA

Judges need to listen to the survivors of Domestic violence and punish those who speak out regardless of who the attorneys are. Not punish for speaking out.

— LESLIE

My goal was to protect my kids and then myself - instead I lost time and then overnights- slowly spent every cent I have earned on attorney fees. I have been to court over 45 times in less than seven years. All but two as a result of my ex filing motions.

— LAUREN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Gangstalking , harassment threatening me tormented and traumatized us. gave a murderer a deal to testify against me in a simple neglect case.
>
> — MEGAN

> Ottawa county family court placed my daughters and me in danger, giving power and control to an abusive man. The institution brought financial devastation to me and my daughter. After four years we are still living in fear, the children are still being abused and we are still struggling financially
>
> — KRIS

> Stolen my daughter and given her to sociopath in the name of the law
>
> — KELSI

> My son's mom basically kidnapped my son, moved about six states away. Press false charges against me to keep me away from my son even longer so she would have full custody.. I went in to court with an attorney within 10 minutes I don't even know what happened it happened so fast My attorney knew that she kidnapped my son never even brought it up to the judge it was automatically how much am I paying child support that was the main subject that had nothing to do with what she had done to me. Now I'm stuck painting an outrageous amount of child support. I can't afford to even go see my son and live at the same time. She agreed to 50% custody but she still wanted the full child support even though she made false allegations against me and she kidnapped my son. The courts in Hillsdale Michigan and Dover Delaware look the other way because they are getting a portion of my child support money. And they have no care of what she had done to me Mentally or psychologically. And worse yet they had no care of how it would affect my son mentally and psychologically as well.
>
> — JOHN

> The system didn’t just fail to protect my children, it became part of the harm by rewarding delay, conflict, and procedure over stability and safety. Instead of reducing trauma, it created and prolonged it.
>
> — KELLY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have to sell my house because I have been being attacked for a year and a half now I have been shot in the arm my truck has been shot up my security cameras have been shot and cops and judge say o well deal with it alcona county michigan is so corrupt it is unbelievable

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Lake County court system in Michigan, actively destroys families. with Judge David Glancy and court administrator, Bobbie Kiefer's home geown domestic terrorist program keeping lake county residents suppressed and in poverty.

— TYLER

complete heaviness and Trauma to my sons and their future.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Family Court has failed my family countless times...this traumatic experience has pained us all. I was forced to abandon my child and my motherhood stolen, my son lost his childhood to satisfy others and all of this happened, with no basis at all.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system victimized my son and myself, while protecting our abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has kept my family apart and kept my children from knowing each other and growing up together. The judges and the front of the court need to be held accountable for keeping families apart for no reason other than they don’t wanna do their job and see the evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system not only forced me into a corner which decimated any of the involved child's best interest but also destroyed my other three children's lives and now we are having to rebuild from scratch, the same system that is supposedly in existence to protect children and families does nothing but destroy them to protect abusers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has broken down family values for profit. I lost 9 years of my children's most influential time of life and have paid an immeasurable price of time for no reason other than county profits.

— JESSICA

The family court system is broken, it is corrupt, and tears families apart. I hope to see my children again and that mothers like myself may give those in the system who've treated us unfairly their comeuppance.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Everything I tried to change the court order. They never gave me a new judge. So I've been stuck in a consistent cycle that will never change.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The judge and referee continue to entertain petty petitions from high conflict mother

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cost me my kids and with them my joy and happiness

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We are technically homeless. I have 3 other children with my spouse. We lost our home because of the broken court system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has perpetuated ongoing abuse and control. It has taught me you are allowed to leave the burning house but your children will not be allowed to escape . It has financially crippled me which prevents activities and vacations in my children's childhood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Robbed me of raising my children and watching them grow

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my 18-year-old autistic daughter away from The only home and family she's ever known

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

STOLEN TIME AWAY FROM MY CHILDREN, PAYING CHILD SUPPORT AND STILL PAYING FOR MORE THAN 50% OF EVERYTHING FOR CHILDREN, NOT BEING ABLE TO COMMUNICATE DIRECTLY WITH THE CHILDREN FOR DAYS AND WEEKS AT A TIME.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have been followed, harassed, tracked, mail has been stolen so I didn't show up to a unknown court date, purjuy, alienation, identity theft has occured, my house has been broken into an have been watch, Judge said she would not look at all the evidence of a disabled child being neglected and abused because I am a veteran being accused of dv which never ever happen.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed my family, destroyed our lives and made me homeless.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my family, our bonds. Ive lost everything more than once now Pain beyond measure..... I hate opening my eyes everyday knowing I have to live another day like this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It broke us physically and mentally. I'm advocating for my daughter Tichina Sanders. This is her story. Cps fabricated lies and the judge went along with it by not looking at her evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

We will never get back what we lost.

— ROBERTA

Years of mistreatment and abuse from the system has caused major issues within my family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Navigating this process has placed prolonged emotional and financial strain on my family while we work toward reunification, stability, and a sense of normalcy for my children.

— MOLLY

I am bankrupt and hardly surviving, 8 years and I am financially ruined and every bit of savings and retirement gone. I thank god my children are safe with me-due to a violent attack and the other parent the attacker-family court is now forcing visits or jail for me. I am threatened while the convicted child abuser is given parenting time.

— KERRY

The system has literally made me terrifies of being a parent.

— JOSHUA

Created years of psychological and emotional damage, financial damage

— MATT

It caused me such emotional harm and mental health issues

— CHRIS

The system has made my family estranged and kept my daughter's separated and my 5 year old isolated

— JENNIFER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The destruction of my family has changed every part of my life. Living through years of separation from my daughter has created a level of grief and trauma that is hard to put into words. Every holiday, birthday, school event, and milestone that passes is another reminder of everything we've lost. The repeated trips back to court have only added to that trauma. Each hearing brings hope that maybe this time things will change, only to leave feeling like we're no closer to healing or being reunited. Instead of finding solutions, we've spent years reliving the same pain over and over. It's emotionally exhausting, financially draining, and has left our entire family living in a constant state of uncertainty. This hasn't only affected me. It has affected my husband, my children, my extended family, and most importantly, my daughter. Relationships that should have been built naturally have instead been replaced with distance, missed memories, and unanswered questions. We've missed birthdays, holidays, sporting events, family dinners, and countless everyday moments that can never be recreated. Despite everything, I have never stopped loving my daughter or hoping for the day our family can begin to heal. No family should have to endure years of separation while repeatedly returning to court without moving any closer to a resolution. The emotional toll of living in that cycle has been devastating for all of us.

— TARA

I went to the Frind the court to get help with child support from a man that showed no interest in his child and had a long history of drug abuse. Instead, I had to file bankruptcy borrow money from everybody just to keep my son safe from him after her, ignoring all the evidence. To this day, I still haven't gotten child support, even though it was ordered, but yet she put my son at risk numerous times. I went to them for help and instead they took away all the safety and security that I had earned on my own. I went for help, instead she destroyed my life.

— LAUREN

The decisions made in my case destroyed the life I had spent years building. I lost my home, my career, my family support network, and significant time with my son, suffering consequences that no parent should endure without a fair and lawful process.

— NICOLE

FOC has suppressed the relationship with my son with no care about his heart in the future.

— TAYLOR

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My family has been completely ripped apart, My children are so confused about what is right and wrong, They have learned to lie into their back on the ones that love them the most. I cannot even blame them because they are being taught that when you do right and when you stand for what you believe that you are still not right. I am desperate for the reunification of my entire family. I am having such a hard time because no matter what I do at this point it feels wrong, but I know that it is right and I will never give up on my children.

— ANGELA

This system has cause physical and emotional destress in my children and I. We are moving because of the harassment and unlawful removal with no evidence.

— ERIKA J

This System Destroys families and tries to Ruin Family Bonds!

— DANIELLE

Raped, convicted, drained, and Murdered the future for the next generation of family.

— EMILY

Constant constitutional violations and extortion

— DAVID

In family court, we learned that proving harm can be harder than surviving it.

— LAUREN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

People ask me what the system did to my family, and the truth is, it didn't just take my children—it took years of our lives that we can never get back. My family was torn apart. My daughters were removed and ultimately adopted, only to later endure years of abuse in the home that was supposed to keep them safe. While they suffered, I spent years fighting to be heard, trying to get people to look at the evidence instead of the assumptions that had already been made about me. The hardest part isn't just what happened—it's knowing that so many opportunities existed to stop it. There were professionals whose job was to protect children, and somewhere along the way, that protection failed. My children paid the price. The system didn't just affect me. It affected every one of my children, my husband, our extended family, and the relationships we should have been able to build over the last decade. It stole birthdays, holidays, graduations, everyday moments, and memories that no court can ever give back. Despite everything, I refused to give up. I kept fighting because my children deserved someone who would never stop believing in them. My story isn't about revenge. It's about accountability. No family should have to endure what mine has, and no child should spend years in danger while the adults responsible for protecting them look the other way. I can't change the past, but I can use my voice to fight for change so that what happened to my family doesn't happen to another.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system, paid by our taxes, should protect victims of assault, however there is a funnel of money going towards trafficking kids instead because they know you'll do anything to try to get them back. Its been impossible to hold them accountable. They ruined my life and family relationships.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have denied a child a life with both parents and lack of support to the child due to having to present things in a special way. When abuse is occurring, it shouldnt matter how you get the proof to the courts, it should be looked at!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has denied my child a sense of safety, and taken away her childhood. She say she wishes she could just be a kid. I have always encouraged her to feel free to love both parents and not choose sides and her love for her mother is weaponized to traumatize her further. She has to go and be with a parent that beat and verbally abused her sibling and watch as the system didn’t punish her and actually tries to push her into accepting her mom is safe despite her continued fear that her mom will hit her again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Completely destroyed!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I've lost my kids, my house, and my hope for justice. I finally ceded custody to my kids father to make the court abuse stop. He does not allow them to speak to me or see me, although they live one mile away. My eldest attempted suicide after returning from Turning Points (NY) and has not spoken to me in three years. I've missed his college, and so many milestones. His sister came back. The two small ones are still trapped. They're all scared of their dad cutting them off financially. It sucks to wait and hope one day they might just heal. The whole system never did anything but exploit their dad's rage and money for profit.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Friend of Court, in an effort to be fair to an absent man with abusive past and record, gave majority of custody to him. The following abuse has done indescribable damage to our child that will take years of therapy to unravel.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> What began as a misunderstanding escalated into a system intervention that separated a mother from her children, disrupted our family relationships, and caused emotional, financial, and psychological harm that continues to affect us today.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Gave me PTSD my oldest a drug problem and broke our family apart
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system tore our family apart and made us look like monsters. All we wanted was safety in our home.tgrre has been four years of heartache and fear due to unjust court system
>
> — JENNIFER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Made my Mom a single Mom of her grandbabies and made me homeless because of one dirty drug screen.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Me and my son's relationship is destroyed. My son is currently failing to launch at life failing school and missing school on drugs drinking at 14 and the court system is doing nothing about it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stole my kid unjustified and caused irreparable harm

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My kids are living in fear and come home sick all the time, emotional wrecks, they are fawning constantly, terrified to do anything wrong, exhausted, depressed, always a mental breakdown when they get back in my custody because they can finally have emotions.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The systemhas thrown me in jail and refuses to let me contest praternity

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Creating orders with no factual evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm being set up to become a payer to the Title IV-D system. My ex made false allegations, sent multiple death threats and still has more custody than me. I make more money so guess who doesn't get to see their kid.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My children and I had such a joyfilled relationship and they trusted that I would protect them after what happened. I told them the courts would see the truth, we just had to trust the process, and that everything would be OK. It wasn't. Everything was taken from us. That was nearly nine years ago and I have not been able to see my children nor do I know where they were moved even though my ex had multiple CPS records and incidents known by therapists. The children lost their mother, their siblings, their maternal family, their home, their trusted doctors and other professionals, their trusted friends, their financial assets, their safety, and their hopes and dreams. Me too. They do not know their mother has never stopped fighting for them. They do not know how much they are missed by their mother, her family, or their friends. I do not know if they are happy or if they have true personal agency. They were robbed of their childhood. I was robbed of motherhood. I do not even know if they are alive. No mother ought ever bear such agony.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Set my family aside for now and almost killed me I can't understand this broken system taht we set is against us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Coercion, harassment, intimidation, walked in our home without a warrant unlawfully, lies, death, newborn injuries in state care

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Since 2020, the family court system has upheld an ex parte custody order issued while I was in rehab, maintaining supervised visitation and imposing over $20,000 in child support debt despite my zero income and finalized divorce in 2021. This outcome reflects a system that protects wealth and retaliation over rehabilitation, fairness, and the long-term emotional well-being of my children.

— JENNY

Lost my job, forced to sell our home, lost our property in a storage unit, they kidnapped our newborn and labeled us dangerous to him, can see 4 out of 5 of my kids, wife has passed away now from a heart attack from postpartum

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Judge Cholack pushing off motions to other people of the court to handle it because he doesn't want too. It failed to see the narcissistic ways of my ex and the damage he has created to my daughter. Proof and evidence all ignored. Motions signed and ignored by ex. Haven't spoke to my daughter since may 2nd 2025
>
> — HOLLY

> Enabled a controlling, abusive man to continue escalating his bad behavior through lack of any form of accountability and by using our property and son as leverage.
>
> — ALLEY

> The system has exploited my mental health crisis for funding, along with keeping their caseloads up.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I am a human trafficking survivor and my son was taken by force being trafficked in the system after the referee order for him not to go into foster care! If the Lord did not bless with the 10K, my son would be gone trafficked off in the system from discrimination, having a gentic disorder and lies!
>
> — WILHELMINA

> This almost killed me AND my child! I've lost trust and respect for the people involved in making and allowing this to happen to us, and allowing it to go on so long!
>
> — TIFFANY

> The system has broken my family, my daughters paternal family hasn't been able to see her in 10+ months has destroyed my life financially, destroyed my parents financially, has emotionally destroyed not only me but my parents , my nieces, my brother and sister in law . This has caused devastation within our entire family
>
> — NICK

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Oakland County Judge Savin should've protected me from a habitual criminal offender. I was told getting a PPO was easy and that it shouldn't be a big deal. $9K later we are still paying for it. We are bound by a document that was signed under duress because of Judge Savin's phone call that told my lawyer for me to stop calling the police. I was in fear of my life based on all the domestic violence charges she had, the felon assault she had, and the neighborhoods she ran from. We were doxxed, filmed in court, people sat outside our gouse, she placed life size court photos of us in her yard. She did this all while on probation from an earlier assault charge. She was given a criminal trespass for being on my property while I had a ppo against her that I had to pay for because the Clarkston police wouldn't mess with her. Judge Savin didn't mind that this women on probation was allowed to cause all this ruckus. If judge Savin would've done her job that day I wouldn't still be reeling every time someone in a suit shows up in my house. The PTSD is very real and shame on her for doing that to me. We have/had all the documents and she didn't care. No family judge should be handling criminal PPO's.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court has torn apart my family by separating my youngest child from all of his siblings and me, his mother. Now he is being raised by his grandmother, in her sons name. She wanted my son, not him. She won.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I no longer believe in people, the courts, or the system. It is not there to help or protect. I have no hope. My beliefs have been shattered. feel broken, a shell of the person I was.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has taken literal years away from my daughter and I. She is only 3, and I have been forced yo miss so much. Tons of proof that I wanted everything to do with being there every day for her. Has cost me over $15,000 and that all could and should be for my daughter. The judge took away extra time just to child support would go up. Even though it was never even said that I was a bad Father.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have put wrong information down. They've given me zero custody straight off the bat which have taken my daughter's time away from me, which is my only child. They've taken advantage of me by using my PTSD and mental health issues.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Safety is when you know you are safe, it's when you know that your parents are safe, it's when you can lay your head down at night and go to bed peacefully it's when you can tell your parents that you love them and give them a hug but once foster care takes you, you never know when you'll be safe again, you don't know when you will be able to lay your head down at night and fall asleep peacefully you don't know if your parents are okay and your biggest worry is your parents and your siblings at the end of the day but you're also so angry because the court took that all away from you.

— NEVAEH

The system has separated my child from me and from her grandparents, who are now afraid to see her due to my ex sending our daughter in to professionals with false allegations and has caused the permanent loss of irreplaceable time. It has also resulted in the loss of my home, savings, and financial stability while the situation continues without resolution.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was denied due process, denied the right to speak on the record, coerced into a plea agreement and still fighting for reunification. I was triangulated out of my oldest child's life and haven't seen him in over 3 years due to court orders suspending my visitation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The System has put my child in the hands of an abusive parent. The system believes fairness for the parents over my child's safety and multiple sources of proof and professionals input.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm trying to fight filed DOJ complaint and the consistuinal violations I don't get to see my only son and I'm a good man. No record she has tried to has me jailed caused me to loose my job of 24 years with abuse of process with her scum lawyer! I'm trying to sue then but she has hired two lawyers against me now trying to damage my integrity an my life has been ruined. I'm sick what she has done to me please help me please

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Financially devastating.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

137 full approved Michigan comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Michigan report comes from Michigan respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Michigan — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 200 Michigan families reporting here are not the universe of Michigan families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – November 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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